**Q. Considering the recent NGT verdict, what conditions or safeguards have been mandated?**

The National Green Tribunal noted that specific conditions were incorporated in the Environmental Clearance (EC) for the protection of Leatherback Sea Turtle, Nicobar Megapode, Saltwater Crocodiles, Nicobar Macaque, Robber Crab and other endemic bird species of GNI, besides the impact of invasive species on native flora, and on inter-tidal flora and fauna, mangrove restoration, coral translocation and welfare of Shompen and Nicobarese people, and directed the authorities and the regulatory agency to ensure full and strict compliance with these. The EC also mandates construction of two all-weather research stations at Campbell Bay and Kamorta, to be exclusively used by institutions such as the Wildlife Institute of India (WII), Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) and maintained by the Project Proponent for the entire project duration.

**Q. What else is the project proponent required to do?**

The Project Proponent must provide separate funds to the A&N forest department for oversight of conservation and mitigation work, infrastructure and operational costs towards implementation of conservation plans for Leatherback Sea Turtle, Nicobar Megapode, Saltwater Crocodile and other endemic flora and fauna, over and above the costs recommended for key institutions such as WII, SACON (Salim Ali Centre for Ornithology and Natural History), ZSI, BSI (Botanical Survey of India) and the A&N forest and tribal welfare departments. The EC provides for three independent monitoring committees to oversee matters related to pollution, biodiversity and the welfare of the Shompen and Nicobarese, as part of the implementation of the environmental management plan.

**Q. What consultations have been held with indigenous communities and rehabilitation guarantees offered, particularly to displaced or affected Shompen and Nicobarese?**

The impact on indigenous communities was examined by the empowered committee constituted under the Andaman & Nicobar (Protection of Aboriginal Tribes) Regulation, 1956. The committee included senior government officers, a joint secretary from the tribal affairs ministry, representatives from the Anthropological Survey of India, and renowned anthropologists to ensure protection of tribal interests. The committee deliberated the proposal for the denotification of the tribal reserve area and recommended that the interests of tribal people, especially the Shompen (a particularly vulnerable tribal group) not be adversely affected.

**Q. Were there any specific stipulations by this committee?**

The committee specifically stipulated that displacement of tribal communities would not be permitted. The only habitations of Shompen or Nicobarese within the project area are at New Chingen and Rajiv Nagar, and the administration has stated it is not proposing the displacement of any tribal habitation. Clearance conditions mandate geo-fencing and surveillance systems equipped with optical/thermal cameras, satellite phones, drones and wireless systems to protect tribal habitats from trespassers and poachers. A monitoring committee under the chairmanship of the deputy commissioner (Nicobar) will oversee welfare and issues of the Shompen and Nicobarese. A 50-year tribal welfare plan has been mandated under the environmental and CRZ clearances, with dedicated financial allocation. It includes welfare measures, infrastructure development and establishment of a special medical unit equipped with modern facilities, medicines and qualified medical staff to monitor human-induced diseases due to the expected population influx. The administration has committed to implementing the tribal welfare plan throughout the project period and beyond. The collector (land acquisition) is assigned the responsibility of working out the rehabilitation and resettlement (R&R) plan.



**“The only Nicobarese-Shompen habitations in the project area are at New Chingen and Rajiv Nagar. The administration has said it does not propose displacing them”**

**Q. Are the members of the tribal communities onboard with these plans?**

The chairman of the tribal council (Great Nicobar & Little Nicobar) attended the January 27, 2022, public hearing on environmental clearance and EIA (environmental impact assessment) for the project on behalf of the tribal community. Subsequently, the tribal council submitted its views and comments on the social impact assessment (SIA) report vide letters dated Aug. 11, 2025, and Aug. 27, 2025. The A&N administration also informed the National Commission for Scheduled Tribes that all procedures mandated under the Act, Regulations and Policies have been followed.

**Q. What does the government propose to do in order to ensure that dredging, port activity and increased vessel traffic during construction and utilisation of the**